

4. Add “safety action”: turn off geyser plug (if it’s on a smart plug rated for it – otherwise skip and use a timer switch).
5. Test: run it from voice and from the app.

Upgrade: Add a “last chance” 60-second delayed lights-off in the living room so nobody gets stranded mid-walk.

3) Gentle wake-up

- Goal: Bedroom lights ramp up slowly and predictably.
- Ingredients: dimmable light/switch, optional smart speaker.
- Trigger: time of day (weekday).
- Actions: gradually increase brightness; optional “brief” audio.

Steps

1. Create a weekday schedule (Mon–Fri) at your wake time.
2. Action 1: set bedroom light to 10% brightness.
3. Action 2: after 2 minutes, go to 30%, then 60%.
4. Keep it consistent – don’t overcomplicate with weather and sleep tracking yet.
5. Add a weekend variant with a later time.

Platform hint: Google scripted automations support time starters and multi-step actions; Apple automations can run at a time of day; HA actions can chain steps; Alexa routines can run schedules with actions.

4) Movie mode (the “wow, okay” scene)

- Goal: One tap = living room transforms for TV.
- Ingredients: living room lights, optional smart plugs (bias light), optional curtains/blinds.
- Trigger: voice phrase (“Movie time”) or TV turns on (if supported) or a button.
- Actions: dim main lights, turn on bias light, switch off noisy lights.

Steps

1. Build a Movie Scene:
 - main lights: 20–30%
 - bias light: ON
 - anything reflective/glary: OFF
2. Trigger it via a routine: voice command or a “Watch TV”



shortcut. Alexa routines can tie multiple actions to one voice command; Apple scenes are designed for this exact use.

3. Add a condition: only after sunset (so you don’t darken the house at noon).
4. Create an “End Movie” scene that restores lights to normal.

Upgrade: If your ecosystem supports it, trigger Movie Mode when the TV plug draws power (smart plug with energy monitoring) – but keep manual override available.

5) Away mode

- Goal: When nobody is home, the house behaves like nobody is home – safely.
- Ingredients: presence detection (phone location), optional cameras, door/window sensors, a few lights.
- Trigger: last person leaves.
- Actions: arm cameras, turn off non-essential plugs, enable random evening light.

Apple Home supports automations based on people arriving/leaving, and it explicitly requires Share My Location for invited users for location-based triggers. Google scripted automations include examples based on household presence.

Steps

1. Enable presence/location for the home members who count.
 2. Create “Away Mode” automation: when the last person leaves → turn off lights/plugs.
 3. If you use cameras: turn them ON only in Away Mode.
 4. Add a condition: don’t arm cameras if a trusted guest/cleaner mode is enabled (see recipe #10).
 5. Add a small “random light” between 7–11 PM for lived-in vibes.
- Upgrade:** Add notification only for “door opens while away” (don’t notify for every motion; you’ll stop caring).

6) Welcome home (entry light + comfort, instantly)

- Goal: First person arrives, entry light turns on and the home goes “safe”.
- Ingredients: presence, optional door sensor, entry light, optional AC.
- Trigger: first person arrives / door unlocks (if supported).
- Actions: entry light on, disable cameras, set comfort temp.

Steps

1. Choose the trigger: “People Arrive” (Apple), Home presence mode (Google), geofence/presence (HA), or location routine (Alexa/phone integration where available).
2. Condition: only after sunset for lights; always for cameras-off (if you arm them).
3. Action: entry light ON for 5 minutes.
4. Optional action: AC to a mild preset (don’t blast; comfort beats theatrics).